

Trophy

Jon Baker's Pars Break The Field

Six points clear of Gregg Williams over four Kent links, the champion never finished a round worse than third of five — and his 44 at Littlestone was where the argument ended.

Jon Baker took the lead in the TEG 13 Trophy at the second hole of the opening round at Royal Cinque Ports and then, with one brief lapse in security, refused to give it back. He finished on 158 points, six clear of Gregg Williams.

The lapse came late on the second day. Baker had held the Stableford lead for 32 holes across two rounds when a par at the 16th at Prince's Dunes/Himalayas proved insufficient, and Gregg Williams moved in front. Baker had it back almost immediately. Williams's tenure at the summit was real, was earned, and is best measured in minutes.

Round three at Littlestone, the third of four links courses in Kent, was where the matter

was settled. From the 8th to the 11th he did not drop a gross shot: par, birdie at the short 9th, par at the stroke-index-one 10th, par. Thirteen points across four holes. It has the rhythm of a man filing paperwork correctly. His gross round of 79, eight over par, is the second-best gross round recorded in TEG history to that point. Gregg Williams, to his considerable credit, answered with 15 points from the 6th to the 10th and his own best gross of the tournament, 86, and the pair finished the day level at the top of the Trophy, with Baker also leading the TEG 13 Green Jacket.

Across the four rounds Baker recorded 34 pars or better, an all-time TEG record.

AT A GLANCE
Trophy Winner Jon Baker (3rd Trophy) Runner-up: Gregg Williams
Green Jacket Jon Baker (3rd Jacket) Runner-up: Gregg Williams
Wooden Spoon David Mullin (4th Spoon) Next above: John Patterson

FINAL · Trophy
JB 158 | GW 152 | AB 141 | JP 141 | DM 135
FINAL · Green Jacket
JB +50 | GW +68 | DM +80 | AB +103 | JP +106

John Patterson

Forty-Nine At Littlestone, Eights Everywhere Else

John Patterson arrived as the TEG 12 Trophy holder, posted the third-best round in TEG history and a personal-best gross at Littlestone, and bracketed it with quadruple bogeys at Royal Cinque Ports and Prince's — finishing six points clear of the Spoon.

John Patterson's TEG 13 was a study in extremes across four Kent links, all four of them new to him.

It began badly. At Royal Cinque Ports he opened with an 8 at the 1st, added a 9 at the 7th, another 8 at the 10th and a 9 at the par-5 16th, the last of which deposited him at the bottom of the TEG 13 Wooden Spoon race. He signed for 108. Friday at Prince's Dunes/Himalayas offered no revision of the thesis: 11 shots bled over the first four holes,

another eight lost between the 13th and 15th, 8s at the 1st and the 17th, 105 on the card and 28 points.

Then Littlestone. Patterson went round in 83, a personal-best gross round at +12, and took 49 Stableford points, the third-best round in TEG history to date. He gathered 13 points in four holes from the 8th, including a net eagle at the stroke-index-one 10th, and still found room for a 7 at the par-3 17th. The 21-point swing between the Friday round and the Saturday was the swing of the tournament.

The final round at Prince's Shore/Dunes settled at 36 points, 13 fewer. It contained both his best and worst single holes of the tournament: an eagle three at the par-5 2nd, the only eagle recorded by anyone in TEG 13 and the first eagle in TEG history, and a 9 at the par-5 15th. He is the only man ever to have made an eagle in this competition. He is also, on the same scorecard, entirely capable of a nine.

Alex Baker

Alex Baker Saves His Best For Last

Last in the Wooden Spoon race at Littlestone's ninth after an eight at the second, Alex Baker replied at Prince's with 44 points and the best gross round of his TEG career.

Alex Baker's time in Kent turned on its final two days. Littlestone, on the Saturday, was where it came apart. He opened with a double bogey, then a quadruple-bogey eight at the 2nd and another double at the 3rd. Eight gross shots gone in three holes, and the round barely under way. The bleeding resumed at the turn: a triple bogey at the 8th, a double at the par-three 9th and another double at the 10th cost seven more. The five at the 9th was the decisive one. It dropped him to the bottom of the TEG 13 Wooden Spoon race, last of the five, having begun the hole a place clear. He signed for 32 points and a gross 100.

It was not an isolated event so much as a habit. He had run up a quadruple-bogey eight at the 11th at Royal Cinque Ports in round one, going three holes from the 10th without a net par, and at Prince's on the Friday he closed with five consecutive double bogeys, ten shots dropped over the last five holes. There is something almost administrative about five straight doubles. Nothing worsened. Nothing improved. The hours simply passed.

The answer came on the Sunday at Prince's Shore/Dunes. Baker made pars at the 1st and 2nd, then paired them again at the 9th and 10th, and came home in +17 gross, a personal best for a single round. His 44 points were a 12-point improvement on Littlestone.

Green Jacket

Eighteen Clear: Jon Baker's Third Straight Jacket

The gross lead was nine after Royal Cinque Ports and only ever grew; a +8 at Littlestone, the second-best gross round TEG has recorded, turned a competition into an inspection.

Jon Baker won the TEG 13 Green Jacket with a gross total of +50, finishing eighteen shots clear of Gregg Williams. It is the lowest gross aggregate recorded in TEG history, and comfortably the best of Baker's own career.

The margin was built on consistency across four links courses, all of them new to the field on this first visit to Kent. Baker opened with 85 at Royal Cinque Ports, added 88 over Prince's Dunes/Himalayas, and closed with 85 on the Shore/Dunes combination. Fifty over par for four rounds is not golf anyone would frame. It was, in this field, an act of near-monastic discipline. The round that separated him came on the Saturday at Littlestone, where he went round in 79, eight over par and the second-best gross round anyone has produced in a TEG. By the end of that third day he led the Jacket outright, and he also headed the TEG 13 Trophy on Stableford, level at the top with nothing between him and the chasing player.

The underlying number explains the eighteen shots. Baker made 34 pars or better across the four rounds, more than any player has managed in a single TEG. That is an average of better than eight clean holes a round on unfamiliar links. Against the rest of this scorecard evidence, it borders on the discourteous, and it left his rivals with no route back into the gross contest at any stage.

Wooden Spoon

David Mullin Completes The Spoon Hat-Trick

Eight prior Green Jackets, two prior Trophies and the most consistent scoring of anyone here still added up to 135 points and last place, sealed by a nine at Prince's tenth.

David Mullin finished in Kent with 135 Stableford points, the lowest total in the field, and collected the TEG 13 Wooden Spoon. It is his third in succession.

Nothing about it was sudden. Across four links courses, none of which he had played before in TEG competition, his gross scores were 94 at Royal Cinque Ports, 89 over Prince's Dunes/Himalayas, 92 at Littlestone and 92 on the Shore/Dunes combination that closed the tournament. Five strokes separate his best round from his worst. In most walks of life that reliability would be a virtue. Here it functioned as a tether, keeping him within reach of the bottom place from Thursday onwards.

The matter was formalised at the 10th at Prince's in the final round. Mullin took nine shots on the par 4. A quintuple bogey, no Stableford points, on a stroke index 3 hole. It is the worst score he has recorded on a par 4 in TEG competition, which given the sample size available is a genuine achievement of sorts. He arrived at the tee second from bottom in the Spoon race. He left it last. He stayed there.

The Spoon is decided on Stableford points, and 135 across four rounds was never going to be enough to escape it. Mullin's tournament was defined less by disaster than by the complete absence of any round good enough to lift him clear.

Records & Personal Bests

Notable achievements: TEG 13

TEG Records

- John Patterson's 49 pts is the 3rd-best round in TEG history to date (R3)
- Jon Baker's +8 (gross) is the 2nd-best Gross round in TEG history to date (R3)
- Jon Baker's +50 is the best Gross total in TEG history

Personal Bests

- Alex Baker posts a personal-best Gross round: +17 (R4)
- John Patterson posts a personal-best Gross round: +12 (R3)
- Jon Baker's +50 is a personal Gross best

Rare Feats

- John Patterson eagles the par-5 2nd (R4)
- David Mullin runs up a 9 (+5) at the 10th (R4) — his career-worst on a par-4